Garbage Stayman

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Garbage Stayman is a rare but fun little variation of the Stayman convention. After a 1NT opening by partner, a 2♣ response shows a weak 3-suited hand that's short in clubs. Playing a strong 15-17 1NT, Garbage Stayman shows 0-7 points. The ideal distribution is 4-4-4-1 or 4-4-5-0, although 3-4-5-1 or 4-3-5-1 is also okay. Note that a weak hand containing a 5-card major (e.g. 5-4-4-0 shape) should simply use a Jacoby Transfer instead.

Some examples of hands suitable for a Garbage Stayman response:

♠T987 ♥A984 ♦87532 ♣—	♠Q653 ♥Q432 ♦T975 ♣J	♠J872 ♥JT4 ♦86543 ♣9

With each of these hands, responder bids 2♣ like regular Stayman. However, responder intends to **pass** at his next turn. The idea is that the partnership will either locate an 8-card major suit fit, or a probable 8-card diamond fit if opener denies a 4-card major.

Opener's Rebids

Opener's rebids are the same as in regular Stayman:

Opener's Rebid	Meaning
2♦	Denies a 4-card major
2♥	Shows 4 (or rarely 5) hearts, and may have 4 spades
2♠	Shows 4 (or rarely 5) spades, and shows fewer than 4 hearts

Examples

West	East
♠T3 ♥AQ82 ♦KJ7 ♣KQT5	♠8652 ♥KT93 ♦8654 ♣2

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♥	All Pass		

This is the textbook hand that Garbage Stayman attempts to solve. You can cheaply find your 4-4 major suit fit rather than languish in 1NT.

West	East
♠KT95	♠J87
♥AK3	♥Q642
♦A5	♦K9873
♣QJT9	♣2

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♠	All Pass		

On the other hand, you may also create some sticky situations with imperfect shape. Here 1NT was an acceptable contract but 2♠ will require some maneuvering.

See also

- Crawling Stayman
  A convention for showing a weak hand with 4-4 shape in the majors.
- Double-Barreled Stayman
  A convention for distinguishing non-forcing and forcing Stayman hands.
- Keri Response to 1NT
  A scientific alternative to Stayman by expert Ron Klinger.
- Minor Suit Stayman
  A method of showing 4-4 shape or better in the minors.
- Puppet Stayman
  A variant of Stayman for identifying 5-3 major-suit fits.
- Smolen
  An extension of Stayman for showing 5-4 shape in the majors.
- Stayman
  The original convention for responding to 1NT to find a 4-4 major-suit fit.